demand for other models. It has made LPK 2516, a tipper that has the Cummins engine, a market leader for instance, a position it continues to retain. It has over 50 per cent market share, Srivastav says.

The changes that Ratan and his team brought about were reflected in the attitude of customers, particularly the large ones. Speaking about the changes in the quality of Tata commercial vehicles and the company's impressive customer care, Kiran Shah adds that the changes brought about when Ratan was at the helm of Tata Motor were 'significant'. They were made to feel that they were part of the Tata 'family', he adds.

He and his son, Nishal Shah, who is also a director in Swan Carriers, add that the quality of some models is not only as good as the European makes like Scania and Mercedes, but are 35–40 per cent cheaper than them. Commenting specifically on the Tata truck LPT 2515, he says that it was a 'wonderful truck' and that they ran it for twenty years. The quality and competitive pricing of Tata Xenon, Tata Novus (heavy duty trucks shipped from Tata Daewoo, Korea), for instance, have today made them shift their reliance to the Tata make; of their current total carrying capacity of 5,500 MT, over 54 per cent (3,000 MT) comes from Tata made trucks.

With demand increasing and working to expand overseas presence during the period from 1991 to 2012, Tata Motors expanded operations from a single country to eleven. Exports grew substantially. In Africa, Tata Motors' top line grew from $10.2 million in 2002 to $306.40 million in 2013, registering a nearly 80 per cent CAGR.

The Jaguar Land Rover acquisition too helped change the image of Tata Motors. It catapulted the Indian company 'big time' on to the world stage, says Bansal. He says that besides it being a 'proud moment for us', it was evidence that 'Tatas believe in quality' and selling its vehicles became 'much easier'. Bansal is barely able to conceal his joy that the brand belongs to the country of his ancestors—something that he unabashedly flaunts.

The year 2012 marked Ratan's exit as the chairman of the company. In his last statement to the company's shareholders, he ended on a hopeful note: 'Tata Motors will strive to retain its market prominence domestically and internationally and will continue to be a responsible corporate citizen wherever it operates and do the right thing for all its stakeholders and the communities which it serves.'